

Improved credit scores mean less interest and fees being sucked in by the banks and the credit card companies. I say, let's do it!

"If you have poor credit and need to improve it in a hurry, ask a parent or a family member or a close trusted friend to give you a piggyback ride. What that means is they let you join in their good credit rating. They let you ride on their back for awhile.

"Obviously, if your best friend does not have good credit, they are not the person to ask. There has to be someone in your life who does have a good credit history and who will let you be added on to their account. That is how it works.

"They do not have to have a card issued to you. You do not have to ever charge a single cent to the account. You just get the benefit of their good credit because your name will be added to the account, which will soon show up on your credit report as an 'account in good standing.' If you are trying to improve your credit or need to establish credit, this is a marvelous way to do it."

Uh, scratch that. All good things in life must come to an end and this is one of them. Since this book originally went to print, this method has been closed, another door slammed in your face. The folks at the FICO scoring think tank have decided that "authorized users," any name added to an account, really isn't an authorized user—who are they to make that determination?!—and they will no longer include these accounts as part of the credit score for that person. Talk about unfair!

All the accounts out there with additional users—it's now sorry pal, only the first name on the account gets the credit rating. So for all those college kids out there whose parents wanted to give them a head start into the world of good credit, you're outta luck. For all those widows whose devoted sons wanted to help them establish credit in their own names, you're outta luck. And for all the spouses, usually women, who were added to their husband's accounts and thought they were also getting the benefit of the good credit, you're outta luck.

Once again, the innocent person, the little guy (or gal), is getting screwed.